

Support While You Wait

No diagnosis required.

The average Australian family waits over two years between first noticing a concern and getting a diagnosis. MettleNest isn't a replacement for the therapy at the other end of that wait — we're the support for the two years most families are told to just get through alone.

The gap nobody prepares you for

You've noticed something. Maybe it's the school raising concerns, maybe it's your own gut. You've started the process — a referral, a wait list, a name on a spreadsheet somewhere.

And then: nothing, for a long time.

- Autism and ADHD assessment waitlists across Australia have been reported at up to **two years**
- Public system assessments can take **3.5 years** to complete in some regions
- Parents report an average of **12 months and eight appointments** before a diagnosis is reached
- Even after diagnosis, NDIS plan changes carry median waits of around **42 days** — sometimes well over 100

That's before therapy even starts. There's currently very little structured support offered to families during this entire window — which means most people are navigating the hardest, most uncertain stretch completely on their own.

You don't need a diagnosis to start

This is the part most services don't say out loud: **you can access real support right now, before any assessment is complete.**

It's how the NDIS's own Early Childhood Early Intervention (ECEI) pathway already works — available to any child under 6 with a developmental delay, or under 9 with disability, without a diagnosis as a prerequisite. MettleNest works the same way. You don't need a letter from a specialist to start using the BRIDGE Method at home.

If you've been holding off reaching out because you're "waiting to know for sure" — that's exactly the gap this is built for.

What support looks like during the wait

BRIDGE Basics for Parents A self-paced course teaching the BRIDGE Method — the same practical, function-based approach to behaviour that clinics teach in their own short-wait parent training programs, just not badged as "waitlist support." Start using it the same week you sign up.

BRIDGE Coaching One-to-one sessions for your specific situation, when a course alone isn't enough. No diagnosis required to book.

The BRIDGE Behaviour Plan A working document you build together — behaviour, pattern, shared goal, strategies, language, and a review process — so you have something concrete in hand, not just advice to remember.

We're not trying to replace your assessment

To be clear: MettleNest doesn't diagnose, and we're not a substitute for NDIS-funded therapy, a paediatrician, or a psychologist. If those are part of your path, we support that path — we just don't think you should have to wait for a letter to start understanding your child's behaviour and responding to it with more confidence.

FAQ

Do I need a diagnosis to work with MettleNest? No. Many of the families we work with are still on a waitlist, partway through assessment, or have chosen not to pursue formal diagnosis at all. The BRIDGE Method doesn't require one.

Is this a replacement for ABA therapy or NDIS-funded supports? No. MettleNest is designed to sit alongside those services, or to fill the gap before they start. If you're already receiving therapy, BRIDGE gives you a consistent way to reinforce it at home.

What if we get a diagnosis later — do we need to start over? No. Everything you build with BRIDGE (your behaviour plan, your language, your strategies) carries forward. A diagnosis may add new information, but it doesn't undo the work you've already done.
